

Purchase Approval Workflow

Comprehensive User Guide
Odoo 19 Enterprise Module

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Platform	Odoo 19
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14 Advanced Procurement Control Features

01 SLA & Escalation	02 Email Approve/Reject	03 Bulk Approval Dashboard
04 Delegation / OOO	05 Trusted Vendor Bypass	06 Parallel Approval (AND)
07 HR Manager Auto-Routing	08 Level Threshold Check	09 Approval Analytics
10 Change Summary	11 Policy Templates	12 Vendor-Specific Rules
13 Urgency Override	14 Export Audit Trail	

This guide covers installation, configuration, and step-by-step usage of every feature. It is intended for Odoo administrators and purchase managers.

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1. Installation & Dependencies

- **Odoo Version:** 19.0 (Community or Enterprise)
- **Required Modules:** purchase, mail, hr
- **Optional Modules:** None — all 14 features work without additional dependencies
- **Python Packages:** xlswriter (bundled with Odoo), markupsafe (bundled with Odoo)
- **System Packages:** wkhtmltopdf (for PDF audit trail export, already required by Odoo)

Note: Copy the `purchase_approval_workflow` folder to your Odoo addons path, then install it from **Settings** → **Apps** → **Update Apps List**. Search for "Purchase Approval Workflow" and click Install.

2. Quick Start — First Configuration

After installation, follow these four steps to get your first approval workflow running:

Step	Action	Where
1	Enable the workflow	Purchase → Configuration → Settings → Purchase Approval Workflow
2	Apply a Policy Template	Purchase → Configuration → Approvals Workflow → Apply Policy Template
3	Edit the matrix rules	Purchase → Configuration → Approvals Workflow → Approval Matrix
4	Submit a PO for approval	Any Purchase Order → Submit for Approval button

Purchase Orders Products Reporting Configuration									
New Upload Requests for Quotation		Search...		1-19 / 19					
All	13 New	0 RFQ Sent	13 Late RFQ	5 Not Acknowledged	5 Late Receipt	0 % OTD	0.00 Days to Order		
My	8	0	8	3	3	0 %	0.00		
	Reference	Vendor	Buyer	Order Deadline	Activities	Total	Status		
☐	P00019	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Today	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00018	GET Group	E Ekramy		○	920.00 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00017	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00016	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	4,600.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00015	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	690.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00014	ABC	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	3,832.95 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00013	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	51,110.60 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00012	GET Group	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	0.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00011	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	3,680.00 SR	Cancelled		
☐	P00010	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	3,450.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00009	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	11.50 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00008	Ahmed	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00007	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00006	Ahmed Ali	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		

Policy Template Wizard — choose a pre-built layout to create your matrix in one click

3. Approval Matrix — Core Configuration

The Approval Matrix defines **who** approves each purchase order, at which **amount thresholds**, and under what **conditions**. Each row is a rule; the ORM selects the best-matching rule at runtime.

Field	Description
Level	Approval sequence (1 = first to be triggered, 2 = second, etc.)
Amount Range	Min / Max PO total in company currency. Leave both at 0 for any amount.
Approver (User)	A specific user who must approve. Takes priority over Approver Group.
Approver (Group)	Any active member of this group can approve (OR mode) or all must (AND mode).
Use HR Manager	Auto-route to the buyer's manager from the HR Employee hierarchy.
Approval Type	Any One (OR) or All Members (AND). Requires Approver Group.
Vendor	Restrict this rule to a specific vendor.
Department	Restrict to orders from employees in this department.
Product Category	Restrict to orders containing products in this category.
SLA Days	Calendar days allowed before escalation. 0 = no deadline.
Escalate To	User notified and reassigned when the SLA deadline passes.

Level	Rule Name	Approver (User)	Approver (Group)	Min Amount	Max Amount	Department	Product Category	Vendor	Deadline...	Escalate To	Active
Level 1	Manager Approval	Ekramy		0.00 SR	300.00 SR						☒

Approval Matrix list — all active rules with level, approver, and SLA columns

PurchaseOrdersProductsReportingConfiguration

My Company

New

Approval Matrix

Manager Approval (Level 1)

1 / 1

Rule Name

Manager Approval

EN

APPROVAL LEVEL

Level 1

RULE SETTINGS

Active☒

Sequence ? 10

AMOUNT RANGE

Minimum Amount ? 0.00 SR

Maximum Amount ? 300.00 SR

APPROVER

Route to Buyer's HR Manager ?☐

Approver (User) ? Ekramy

Approver (Group) ?

Approval Logic ?

Any One Approver (OR)

All Group Members (AND)

OPTIONAL FILTERS

Vendor ?

Department ?

Product Category ?

SLA & ESCALATION

Deadline (Days) ? 0

Escalate To ?

Notes

Internal notes about this rule...

Approval Matrix form — full rule configuration including SLA and parallel approval settings

Each approval level can have an SLA deadline — a fixed number of calendar days within which the approver must act. A daily cron job checks all overdue orders, sends an overdue reminder email, and reassigns the order to the escalation user.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Open an Approval Matrix rule.
- **Step 2.** Set **Deadline (Days)** to the number of days allowed (e.g. 3).
- **Step 3.** Set **Escalate To** to the user who takes over if the deadline passes.
- **Step 4.** Submit a PO for approval — the **Approval Deadline** field is set automatically.
- **Step 5.** If the deadline passes, the cron sends an overdue email and reassigns the approver.

Note: Enable SLA tracking in Purchase → Configuration → Settings → Purchase Approval Workflow → Enable SLA Tracking.

The screenshot shows the 'Manager Approval' rule configuration form. The form is divided into several sections:

- Rule Name:** Manager Approval (EN)
- APPROVAL LEVEL:** Level 1
- RULE SETTINGS:**
 - Active: ☒
 - Sequence: 10
- AMOUNT RANGE:**
 - Minimum Amount: 0.00 SR
 - Maximum Amount: 300.00 SR
- APPROVER:**
 - Route to Buyer's HR Manager: ☐
 - Approver (User): Ekramy
 - Approver (Group):
 - Approval Logic: ☒ Any One Approver (OR) ☐ All Group Members (AND)
- OPTIONAL FILTERS:**
 - Vendor
 - Department
 - Product Category
- SLA & ESCALATION:**
 - Deadline (Days): 0
 - Escalate To:
- Notes:** Internal notes about this rule...

SLA & Escalation fields at the bottom of the Approval Matrix form

When a PO is submitted for approval, the approver receives an email containing **one-click Approve and Reject buttons**. No login required — clicking the button processes the decision immediately via a secure tokenized URL.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Submit any PO for approval.
- **Step 2.** The approver receives a notification email with green Approve and red Reject buttons.
- **Step 3.** Clicking Approve instantly approves the PO and sends a confirmation email to the submitter.
- **Step 4.** Clicking Reject shows a simple form to enter a rejection reason, then submits it.
- **Step 5.** Tokens are single-use, time-scoped to the current approval state, and cleared after use.

Note: Tokens are cryptographically random (`secrets.token_urlsafe(32)`). They are invalidated when the PO is approved, rejected, reset, or cancelled.

Two dedicated menu items provide a real-time list of all purchase orders awaiting your approval. Each row has inline Approve / Reject buttons, and the Action menu provides a Bulk Approve server action to approve multiple selected orders at once.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Go to **Purchase → My Pending Approvals** to see only orders assigned to you.
- **Step 2.** Go to **Purchase → All Pending Approvals** to see every waiting order (Manager access).
- **Step 3.** Use the checkbox to select multiple orders.
- **Step 4.** Click **Action → Bulk Approve** to approve all selected orders in one step.
- **Step 5.** Or click the inline **Approve / Reject** button on any individual row.

Purchase Orders Products Reporting Configuration									
New	Upload	Requests for Quotation		Search...		1-19 / 19			
All	13 New	0 RFQ Sent	13 Late RFQ	5 Not Acknowledged	5 Late Receipt	0 % OTD	0.00 Days to Order		
My	8	0	8	3	3	0 %	0.00		
☐	Reference	Vendor	Buyer	Order Deadline	Activities	Total	Status		
☐ ☆	P00019	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Today	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00018	GET Group	E Ekramy		○	920.00 SR	Purchase Order		
☐ ☆	P00017	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00016	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	4,600.00 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00015	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	690.00 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00014	ABC	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	3,832.95 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00013	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	51,110.60 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00012	GET Group	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	0.00 SR			
☐ ☆	P00011	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	3,680.00 SR	Cancelled		
☐ ☆	P00010	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	3,450.00 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00009	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	11.50 SR	Purchase Order		
☐ ☆	P00008	Ahmed	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00007	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐ ☆	P00006	Ahmed Ali	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		

My Pending Approvals — inline approve/reject buttons and bulk action

Any approver can delegate their approval authority to another user for a set period. When a PO is routed to a user who has an active delegation, the system automatically routes to the delegate instead and notes this in the chatter.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Go to **Settings** → **Users** and open your user record.
- **Step 2.** In the **Preferences** tab, set **Approval Delegate** to another user.
- **Step 3.** Set **Delegate Until** to the date when delegation ends.
- **Step 4.** POs submitted while you are on leave will route to your delegate automatically.
- **Step 5.** After the end date, routing returns to you normally.

The screenshot shows the 'Preferences' tab for a user named 'Ahmed'. The form includes the following sections and fields:

- User Profile:** Name 'Ahmed', email 'ahmed', and phone number.
- Access Rights:** 'Access Rights', 'Preferences' (active), 'Calendar', and 'Security' tabs.
- Language:** 'English (US)'.
- Notification:** 'By Emails' (selected), 'In Odoo'.
- Email Signature:** 'Ahmed'.
- PURCHASE APPROVAL DELEGATION:**
 - Delegate Approvals To:** A dropdown menu.
 - Delegate Until:** A date selection field.

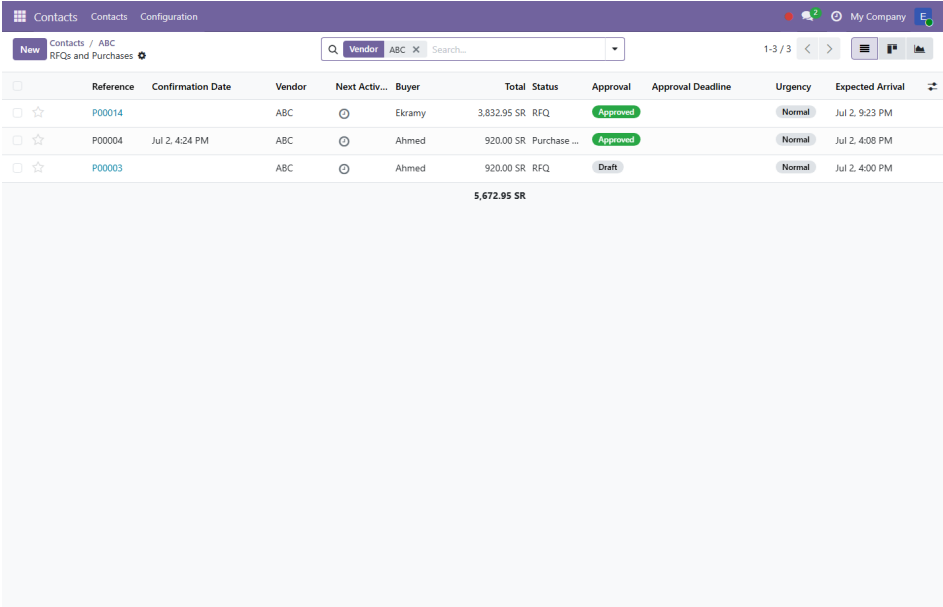
User Preferences — Approval Delegate and Delegate Until fields

Mark specific vendors as **trusted** to skip the entire approval workflow for purchase orders below a configurable amount limit. The order is automatically approved and a chatter note records the bypass.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Open any vendor's contact form.
- **Step 2.** Go to the **Purchase** tab and enable **Trusted Vendor — Skip Approval**.
- **Step 3.** Set **Bypass Limit** to the maximum PO amount eligible for bypass (0 = always bypass).
- **Step 4.** Submit a PO from this vendor — if the total is within the limit, it is auto-approved.
- **Step 5.** The chatter records: *Auto-Approved: Vendor [Name] is marked as a trusted vendor.*

Note: Enable in Settings → Purchase Approval Workflow → Enable Trusted Vendor Bypass.



The screenshot shows the 'Purchase' tab of a vendor contact form. It displays a table of purchase orders with columns for Reference, Confirmation Date, Vendor, Next Activ..., Buyer, Total, Status, Approval, Approval Deadline, Urgency, and Expected Arrival. The table contains three rows of data, with the first two rows marked as 'Approved' and the third as 'Draft'. A total of 5,672.95 SR is shown at the bottom of the table.

Reference	Confirmation Date	Vendor	Next Activ...	Buyer	Total	Status	Approval	Approval Deadline	Urgency	Expected Arrival
P00014		ABC	⊙	Ekrany	3,832.95 SR	RFQ	Approved		Normal	Jul 2, 9:23 PM
P00004	Jul 2, 4:24 PM	ABC	⊙	Ahmed	920.00 SR	Purchase ...	Approved		Normal	Jul 2, 4:08 PM
P00003		ABC	⊙	Ahmed	920.00 SR	RFQ	Draft		Normal	Jul 2, 4:00 PM

5,672.95 SR

Vendor contact form — Trusted Vendor Bypass toggle and limit

By default, any single group member can approve a PO (**OR logic**). Enabling AND logic requires **every active member** of the Approver Group to approve before the workflow advances. Individual votes are tracked in real time.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Open an Approval Matrix rule.
- **Step 2.** Set an **Approver Group** (e.g. Purchase Managers).
- **Step 3.** The **Approval Type** radio button appears — select **All Group Members (AND)**.
- **Step 4.** Submit a PO — each group member receives an approval request email.
- **Step 5.** Each member clicks Approve. The chatter shows who has voted and who is still pending.
- **Step 6.** Only when the last member approves does the workflow advance to the next level.

Note: AND logic is only available when using Approver Group. It has no effect with Approver User.

The screenshot shows the 'Approval Matrix' configuration form for a rule named 'Manager Approval'. The form is divided into several sections:

- Rule Name:** Manager Approval (EN)
- APPROVAL LEVEL:** Level 1
- RULE SETTINGS:**
 - Active: ☒
 - Sequence: 10
- APPROVER:**
 - Route to Buyer's HR Manager: ☐
 - Approver (User): Ekramy
 - Approver (Group):
 - Approval Logic:
 - ☒ Any One Approver (OR)
 - ☐ All Group Members (AND)
- AMOUNT RANGE:**
 - Minimum Amount: 0.00 SR
 - Maximum Amount: 300.00 SR
- OPTIONAL FILTERS:**
 - Vendor
 - Department
 - Product Category
- SLA & ESCALATION:**
 - Deadline (Days): 0
 - Escalate To
- Notes:** Internal notes about this rule...

Approval Matrix form — Approval Type radio: Any One (OR) vs All Members (AND)

When enabled on a matrix rule, Odoo automatically looks up the **HR Employee** record of the user who submitted the PO and routes approval to that employee's manager. No manual approver assignment needed — the approver changes dynamically based on who submitted.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Open an Approval Matrix rule.
- **Step 2.** Enable **Route to Buyer's HR Manager** toggle.
- **Step 3.** Ensure all buyers have HR Employee records with a Manager set.
- **Step 4.** Submit a PO — the workflow finds the submitter's HR manager and assigns them as approver.
- **Step 5.** If no HR manager is found, the system falls back to the rule's Approver User / Group.

Note: Requires the hr module and HR Employee records with the Parent (Manager) field populated.

The screenshot shows the 'Manager Approval' rule configuration in Odoo. The form is divided into several sections:

- Rule Name:** Manager Approval (EN)
- APPROVAL LEVEL:** Level 1
- RULE SETTINGS:**
 - Active: ☒
 - Sequence: 10
- APPROVER:**
 - Route to Buyer's HR Manager: ☒
 - Approver (User): Ekramy
 - Approver (Group):
 - Approval Logic: ☒ Any One Approver (OR), ☐ All Group Members (AND)
- AMOUNT RANGE:**
 - Minimum Amount: 0.00 SR
 - Maximum Amount: 300.00 SR
- OPTIONAL FILTERS:**
 - Vendor:
 - Department:
 - Product Category:
- SLA & ESCALATION:**
 - Deadline (Days): 0
 - Escalate To:
- Notes:** Internal notes about this rule...

Route to Buyer's HR Manager toggle on the Approval Matrix form

While a PO is under review, the **Approval Information** tab shows how the order's total compares to the current approval level's maximum amount. If the order exceeds the level threshold, an orange warning is displayed — approval is still possible but the approver is informed.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Submit a PO for approval.
- **Step 2.** Open the PO form and click the **Approval Information** tab.
- **Step 3.** The **Level Threshold** group shows **Remaining Under Threshold**.
- **Step 4.** A positive value means the PO is within the level's upper limit.
- **Step 5.** An orange warning appears if the PO amount exceeds the level's max_amount.

Note: The threshold is taken from the matched Approval Matrix rule's Max Amount field. No external budget module is required.

The screenshot displays the 'Request for Quotation' form for PO00019. The 'Approval Information' tab is active, showing the 'Level Threshold' group. The 'Remaining Under Threshold' is displayed as a positive value, indicating the PO is within the level's upper limit. An orange warning is present, indicating that the PO amount exceeds the level's max_amount. The form also shows submission details, current approver information, and a rejection section.

Request for Quotation
P00019

Vendor: Ekramy
Vendor Reference:
Currency: SAR
Order Deadline: Jul 3, 5:11 PM
Expected Arrival: Jul 3, 5:11 PM (No data yet)
Deliver To: My Company: Receipts

SUBMISSION
Submitted By:
Submission Date:
Urgency: Normal (selected), Urgent, Critical — Skip Levels

CURRENT APPROVER
Current Approver:
Approval Level: 0
Active Rule:

FINAL APPROVAL
Last Approved By:
Last Approval Date:

REJECTION

NOTES

PO Approval Information tab — Level Threshold remaining and warning

A dedicated analytics screen provides pivot table, bar chart, and trend line views on the complete approval history. Drill down by approver, decision, level, or date to identify bottlenecks, measure cycle times, and monitor SLA compliance.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Go to **Purchase → Configuration → Approvals Workflow → Approval Analytics**.
- **Step 2.** Switch between **Graph** (bar chart), **Pivot** table, and **List** views.
- **Step 3.** Use the **Filters** and **Group By** menus to slice by approver, month, or decision.
- **Step 4.** In Pivot view, rows are approvers, columns are decisions, measure is count.
- **Step 5.** In Graph view, the trend line shows approval volume over time by week.

Purchase Orders Products Reporting Configuration									
New Upload Requests for Quotation		Search...		1-19 / 19					
All	13 New	0 RFQ Sent	13 Late RFQ	5 Not Acknowledged	5 Late Receipt	0 % OTD	0.00 Days to Order		
My	8	0	8	3	3	0 %	0.00		
	Reference	Vendor	Buyer	Order Deadline	Activities	Total	Status		
☐	P00019	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Today	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00018	GET Group	E Ekramy		○	920.00 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00017	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00016	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	4,600.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00015	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	690.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00014	ABC	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	3,832.95 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00013	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	51,110.60 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00012	GET Group	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	0.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00011	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	3,680.00 SR	Cancelled		
☐	P00010	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	3,450.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00009	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	11.50 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00008	Ahmed	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00007	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00006	Ahmed Ali	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		

Approval Analytics — bar chart view grouped by approver and decision

When a buyer edits a rejected PO and resubmits it, the system compares the new state against the snapshot taken at last submission. Any changes are listed in a formatted chatter message — so approvers immediately see what changed and why.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Submit a PO for approval.
- **Step 2.** Approver rejects it with a reason.
- **Step 3.** Buyer clicks **Reset for Editing**, modifies the PO (e.g. changes amount or vendor), then resubmits.
- **Step 4.** The chatter automatically posts: *Changes since last rejection* with a diff list.
- **Step 5.** Detected changes: vendor, total amount, order date, number of order lines.

Home | Orders | Products | Reporting | Configuration
My Company

[New](#)
Requests for Quotation
P00019

\$ Price Comparison

1 / 19 < >

[Send RFQ](#)
[Submit for Approval](#)
[Print](#)
[Cancel](#)

[Draft](#)
[Waiting Approval](#)
[Approved](#)
[Rejected](#)

[Send message](#)
[Log note](#)
[Activity](#)

Request for Quotation

☆ P00019

Vendor ?	Ekramy	Order Deadline ?	Jul 3, 5:11 PM
Vendor Reference ?		Expected Arrival ?	Jul 3, 5:11 PM No data yet
Currency	SAR	☐ Ask confirmation	
		Deliver To ?	My Company: Receipts

Products

Other Information

Approval Information

Today

E Ekramy 5:11 PM

Purchase Order created

SUBMISSION

Submitted By

Submission Date

Urgency ?

- ☒ Normal
- ☐ Urgent
- ☐ Critical — Skip Levels

CURRENT APPROVER

Current Approver

Approval Level 0

Active Rule

FINAL APPROVAL

Last Approved By

Last Approval Date

REJECTION

NOTES

PO chatter showing formatted change summary on resubmission

A one-click wizard creates a complete set of approval matrix rules from a pre-built template. Four templates are provided. After applying, go to the matrix and assign the correct approvers — the structure is already in place.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Go to **Purchase → Configuration → Approvals Workflow → Apply Policy Template.**
- **Step 2.** Choose one of the four templates (see below).
- **Step 3.** Optionally enable **Archive Existing Rules** to replace the current matrix.
- **Step 4.** Click **Apply Template.**
- **Step 5.** Go to Approval Matrix and assign the correct approvers to each generated rule.

Purchase Orders Products Reporting Configuration									
New	Upload	Requests for Quotation		Search...		1-19 / 19		My Company	
All	13 New	0 RFQ Sent	13 Late RFQ	5 Not Acknowledged	5 Late Receipt	0 % OTD	0.00 Days to Order		
My	8	0	8	3	3	0 %	0.00		
	Reference	Vendor	Buyer	Order Deadline	Activities	Total	Status		
☐	P00019	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Today	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00018	GET Group	E Ekramy		○	920.00 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00017	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00016	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	4,600.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00015	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	690.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00014	ABC	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	3,832.95 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00013	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	51,110.60 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00012	GET Group	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	0.00 SR	RFQ		
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☐	P00010	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	3,450.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00009	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	11.50 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00008	Ahmed	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00007	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00006	Ahmed Ali	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		

Policy Template Wizard — four pre-built configurations

Each matrix rule can be restricted to a specific vendor. When a PO is submitted, the system first tries to match a rule with the vendor, then falls back to rules without a vendor restriction. This allows different approval chains for strategic or high-value suppliers.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Open (or create) an Approval Matrix rule.
- **Step 2.** In **Optional Filters**, set the **Vendor** field.
- **Step 3.** This rule will only apply to POs from that specific vendor.
- **Step 4.** Leave **Vendor** empty on other rules for the general case.

The screenshot shows the 'Approval Matrix' configuration interface. The rule is named 'Manager Approval' and is at 'Level 1'. The 'APPROVAL LEVEL' section shows 'Level 1'. The 'RULE SETTINGS' section includes 'Active' (checked), 'Sequence' (10), and 'Approval Logic' (Any One Approver (OR)). The 'APPROVER' section includes 'Route to Buyer's HR Manager' (unchecked), 'Approver (User)' (Ekramy), and 'Approver (Group)' (empty). The 'AMOUNT RANGE' section includes 'Minimum Amount' (0.00 SR) and 'Maximum Amount' (300.00 SR). The 'OPTIONAL FILTERS' section includes 'Vendor' (empty), 'Department' (empty), and 'Product Category' (empty). The 'SLA & ESCALATION' section includes 'Deadline (Days)' (0) and 'Escalate To' (empty). The 'Notes' section is empty.

Approval Matrix — Vendor field in Optional Filters section

Buyers can mark a PO as **Urgent** or **Critical** before submitting for approval. **Urgent** adds a visible badge to the chatter message. **Critical** routes directly to the **highest configured approval level**, bypassing intermediate levels — for time-sensitive emergency procurement.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Open any PO in Draft or Rejected state.
- **Step 2.** Go to the **Approval Information** tab.
- **Step 3.** Set **Urgency** to **Normal**, **Urgent**, or **Critical — Skip Levels**.
- **Step 4.** Submit for approval.
- **Step 5.** The chatter shows an orange URGENT or red CRITICAL badge with the level it was routed to.

Note: Critical routing uses the highest level's max_amount rule. The approver sees the CRITICAL badge prominently in the email.

The screenshot displays the 'Request for Quotation' (P00019) form in the 'Draft' state. The header includes navigation tabs: 'Send RFQ', 'Submit for Approval', 'Print', 'Cancel', 'Draft', 'Waiting Approval', 'Approved', and 'Rejected'. The 'Draft' tab is active. The form fields show: Vendor: Ekramy, Order Deadline: Jul 3, 5:11 PM, Expected Arrival: Jul 3, 5:11 PM, Currency: SAR, and Deliver To: My Company: Receipts. The 'Approval Information' tab is selected, showing a table with one product: '[E-COM07] Large Cabinet' with a quantity of 1.00, unit price of 800.00, and a 15% tax, resulting in a total of 920.00 SR. The 'Activity' tab on the right shows a message from Ekramy at 5:11 PM: 'Purchase Order created'. The 'CRITICAL' urgency state badge is visible in the top right corner of the form header.

PO form header showing CRITICAL urgency state badge

Download the complete approval history as a formatted **Excel (.xlsx)** file or a branded **PDF report**. Both formats support date range, approver, PO, and decision filters. Excel output uses colour-coded rows and formatted columns.

Steps:

- **Step 1.** Go to **Purchase → Configuration → Approvals Workflow → Export Audit Trail**.
- **Step 2.** Set optional filters: Date From / To, Purchase Order, Approver, Decision.
- **Step 3.** The **Matching Records** count updates live as you change filters.
- **Step 4.** Choose format: **Excel (.xlsx)** for spreadsheet analysis or **PDF Report** for archiving.
- **Step 5.** Click **Export** — the file downloads immediately.

Note: The PDF report also appears in the Action menu on the Approval History list view. The Excel file is colour-coded: green rows = approved, red rows = rejected.

Purchase Orders Products Reporting Configuration									
New	Upload	Requests for Quotation		Search...		1-19 / 19			
All	13 New	0 RFQ Sent	13 Late RFQ	5 Not Acknowledged	5 Late Receipt	0 % OTD	0.00 Days to Order		
My	8	0	8	3	3	0 %	0.00		
☐	Reference	Vendor	Buyer	Order Deadline	Activities	Total	Status		
☐	P00019	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Today	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00018	GET Group	E Ekramy		○	920.00 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00017	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00016	Ahmed	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	4,600.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00015	Ekramy	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	690.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00014	ABC	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	3,832.95 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00013	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	51,110.60 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00012	GET Group	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	0.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00011	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	3,680.00 SR	Cancelled		
☐	P00010	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	3,450.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00009	GET Group	A Ahmed		○	11.50 SR	Purchase Order		
☐	P00008	Ahmed	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00007	GET Group	A Ahmed	Yesterday	○	920.00 SR	RFQ		
☐	P00006	Ahmed Ali	E Ekramy	Yesterday	○	138.58 SR	RFQ		

Export Audit Trail wizard — format selector and live record count

18. Security Groups & Access Rights

Group	Can Do
Purchase Approval User	View approval history, submit for approval, view pending list
Purchase Approval Manager	Approve / Reject POs, view all pending, access analytics
Purchase Approval Administrator	Full access: matrix config, policy templates, settings, export, override
Purchase Manager (built-in)	Equivalent to Administrator for approval purposes

19. Settings Reference

All settings are in **Purchase** → **Configuration** → **Settings** under the **Purchase Approval Workflow** section.

Setting	ir.config_parameter key	Default
Enable Purchase Approval Workflow	purchase_approval_workflow.enabled	False
Enable Multi-Level Approval	purchase_approval_workflow.enable_multi_level	True
Enable Email Notifications	purchase_approval_workflow.enable_email_notifications	True
Enable Mail Activities	purchase_approval_workflow.enable_mail_activities	True
Allow Manager Override	purchase_approval_workflow.allow_manager_override	True
Auto-Confirm After Approval	purchase_approval_workflow.auto_confirm_after_approval	False
Enable SLA Tracking	purchase_approval_workflow.enable_sla	False
Enable Trusted Vendor Bypass	purchase_approval_workflow.enable_trusted_vendor_bypass	False
Enable Budget/Threshold Check	purchase_approval_workflow.enable_budget_check	False

The screenshot shows the 'Settings' page for the 'Purchase Approval Workflow' configuration. The sidebar on the left lists various settings categories: CRM, Sales, Credit Control, Calendar, CoreBI, Purchase, Salla Connector, Inventory, Manufacturing, Invoicing, Project, Timesheets, Employees, Attendances, and Point of Sale. The main content area is divided into several sections: 'Users' (with 'Invite New Users' and '2 Active Users'), 'Languages' (with '2 Languages' and 'Add Languages'), 'Companies' (with 'My Company' and '1 Company'), 'Email Templates' (with 'Button Text' and 'Button Color'), and 'Units of Measure'.

Settings page — Purchase Approval Workflow configuration section

20. Technical Reference

Module Structure

- `models/purchase_order.py` — Main workflow logic, all 14 feature methods
- `models/purchase_approval_matrix.py` — Matrix rules model
- `models/purchase_approval_history.py` — Immutable audit trail
- `models/purchase_approval_vote.py` — AND-logic parallel voting records
- `models/res_users_approval.py` — Delegation fields on `res.users`
- `models/res_partner_approval.py` — Trusted vendor bypass on `res.partner`
- `controllers/main.py` — Tokenized email approval HTTP routes (`auth=public`)
- `wizard/purchase_approval_reject_wizard.py` — Rejection reason wizard
- `wizard/purchase_approval_policy_wizard.py` — Policy template wizard
- `wizard/purchase_approval_audit_export_wizard.py` — Excel/PDF export wizard
- `data/cron_data.xml` — Daily SLA cron job (no numbercall in Odoo 19)
- `data/mail_template_data.xml` — 5 email templates with tokenized buttons

Key Technical Decisions

- Dual-state model: `approval_state` (workflow) + `state` (Odoo PO lifecycle), unified by stored computed `display_state`
- Write-lock: PO edits blocked during approval via `write()` override, bypassed with `with_context(approval_workflow_action=True)`
- HTML chatter: all `message_post(body=...)` calls use `markupsafe.Markup` (required in Odoo 19 to prevent auto-escaping)
- Email tokens: `secrets.token_urlsafe(32)`, stored in `approval_token`, cleared on state change, single-use
- Budget check: uses current matrix rule `max_amount` as threshold — no external budget module required
- Parallel voting: `purchase.approval.vote` transient records per order/level/voter, cleaned up after all members vote